



**THEME: TAKING A HOLISTIC
APPROACH TOWARDS GREEN AND
BEAUTIFUL NAIVASHA.**

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NAIVASHA COMMUNITY SERVICE PROJECT REPORT

Protecting the green and beautiful Naivasha

PROJECT TITLE	PROTECTING THE GREEN AND BEAUTIFUL NAIVASHA
THEME	Taking a holistic approach towards green and beautiful Naivasha.
LOCATION	Naivasha sub-county
LEAD INSTITUTION	YGAK – NGO.
KEY PARTNERS	Nakuru county government ,National Environmental management authority, Red Cross youths Naivasha branch , Young Men Christian Association and Kenya Forest Services, Maasai Mara media club
DATES STARTED	1 st to 4 th October 2019.
DURATION TARGET	4 years

Youth lead initiative

YGAK organized a four days' community service project in Naivasha from 1st to 4th October 2014. The general objective of the community service was environmental conservation and building of resilient Cities and Communities to achieve sustainable development. This is after the realization of the critical role played by the youth and young scholars towards realization of sustainable development goals. On the other hand, this project contributes immensely towards career development of the university volunteers through networking, training, experience and research. The projects contribute to the mental growth through team Building activities.

Major development goals are climate action, sustainable cities and communities, protection of the water bodies and blue economy, economic growth and innovations. The project focuses on promoting these objectives through adopting sustainable solutions which include planting trees in learning institutions, creating awareness and educating the local people in order to reduce

improper solid waste disposal which is community health hazard, partnership to cover costs, innovations to make valuable use from the waste as well as raising funds to sustain the project and employment creation through recycling, reusing and regeneration.

During the project, the team was able to learn about the existing gaps and suggested solutions and approaches. Subsequent activities will include engaging the concerned stakeholders, community, partners and researchers and environment conservation awareness other practices so as to guide the best practices towards achieving the set objectives.



Figure 1 volunteers offer volunteer services at Naivasha strong towers children's home .

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We thank the Almighty God for His grace throughout the planning and the implementation of the project.

We wish to thank the University administration from the office of DVC Academic Affairs, Prof Alexander Kahi, Dean of Volunteers, and Dean FASS, Dr. Phyllis Bartoo for the permission, advice, resources, and every effort each of the offices showed towards the team which ensured the success of the project.

We thank:

- National Environmental Management Authority (NEMA)
- Kenya Forest Service (KFS).
- County Government of Nakuru and Naivasha sub-county environment and health offices.
- Ministry of Public Service, Youth and Gender Affairs, South rift Region.
- YGAK volunteers.
- Maasai Mara University Volunteers.
- Kenya Red Cross youths Naivasha branch.
- Young Men Christian Association (YMCA). Community volunteers.

TARGET THEMES	Approach	Why Naivasha?
Climate change mitigation for food security , Strengthening the blue economy in lake Naivasha, Waste management and greening of Naivasha town	Partnership with corporates, government agencies, county government, Schools and individual volunteers.	The decision was influenced by the rapid economic growth which has a direct negative impact on the environment. This include establishment of the dry port, industrial park and SGR. Green and beautiful town will attract more investors to the town boosting economic growth while grown trees will absorb the greenhouse gases emitted from the increased human activities in the area.

ACTIVITIES AND EVENTS

Activities Highlight

SUSTAINABILITY WORKSHOP. The project started with a sustainability workshop facilitated by ministry of youth, gender, culture and social services, Africa youth leadership Forum, Nakuru county government officials and local organizations. The workshop involved engaging the community, Volunteers volunteers and other stake holders to on the role of the community on the environmental conservation and development of the blue economy.

Philanthropy. The volunteers engaged in philanthropic activities by visiting Naivasha safe house rescue center and Naivasha strong towers where they presented donations and offered domestic service to the homes. They identified strong towers children's home as one of the centers where they will; be planting and growing trees in the ongoing project of greening and beautifying Naivasha.

Tree Growing. In partnership with National Environmental Management Authority the volunteers planted more than 300 trees in Millimani and Unity primary schools. For the three days the volunteers watered the trees and regular routine checks will be implemented. Close to 5000 seedlings will

be planted by the volunteers in the next 4 years to addresses Climate change as well as food and Nutrition security through planting of edible trees.

Innovation. The visited Sanitation Company and waste recycling projects around Naivasha town dumpsite. Both turn waste into useful products e.g. clean energy and compost manure respectively. We understand the critical role played by environmental innovation towards employment creation and climate change mitigation.

Community health. In preparation of breast cancer Awareness Month, the volunteers helped Naivasha sub-county referral hospital plant Grass, painting awareness materials and launching of their new palliative care unit for cancer patients. More trees will be planted in the Hospital compound to offer shade for the visitors and increased fresh air.

Town Clean up. In conjunction with Naivasha sub county environment and health offices and community volunteers, the volunteers did a town clean up in Naivasha industrial area.

Blue Economy. The volunteers had Study of blue economy on the impact of climate change and improper waste management on lake Naivasha and the blue economy.

Events per day

DAY 1

Project Sustainability Workshop at YMCA hall Kabati.

The first facilitator was Mrs Charity Maina County Guild Development Director of Kenya Youth Employment Opportunities Program (KYEOP).

She covered issues concerning youths and community involvement towards climate change i.e.

- Youth fund
- Youth empowerment
- Community service as a source solution to climate change.
- KYEOP as a solution to youth unemployment.

2nd Facilitator Gideon Leteya from Africa Youth Leadership Forum (AYLF).

He advocated that community service is not a favor to the community but rather an obligation we ought to accomplish. Topics covered

- Youth leadership in Africa.
- Resources available in Africa.
- Approach to a sustainable project.

3rd Facilitator Mr. James Kagwe. He runs a waste management Organization and Permaculture Center.

He covered:

- Environmental Sustainability practices.
- Urban and rural Waste management.
- Responsible consumption and production.

COMPANY VISIT. SANIVATION

The company turns human waste into energy and products include:

- Charcoal briquettes as a substitute for charcoal
- Logs as a substitute for firewood

The product from this company is a clean source of energy with CO₂ of 0.0003%.

Research by Kenya Forest Service indicates that use of this energy saves approximately 800,000 a trees in a year

Mental health session

The team conducted a Mental health session bringing together YGAK volunteers, Youths from the neighborhood and specialists from Kenya Red cross. The Session gave the young people a chance to open up on various life issues to help reduce the threat of suicide cases and Gender based violence which is a current issue among the young people .

2nd Day

Philanthropic Giving at Naivasha Safe House and Strong Tower Children's Home.

Here Activities involved



Figure 2. Volunteers at Naivasha dumpsite studying waste management practices

- Slashing and splitting firewood.
- Cooking and feeding the children.
- Playing with the children.
- Gifting the children

The Naivasha Dumpsite.

Mr. Kagwe took us through waste management practices that his team, Laikipia Permaculture Centre, was carrying out at the dumpsite.

Here they would divide the waste in to bio-degradable and non-bio-degradable and use degradable waste to form compost manure.

The main challenge is non-biodegradable waste which seems as transferring a problem from business centers and residential areas to the dumpsite. Burning of this waste seems to be creating challenge to our atmosphere.

3rd Day.

Tree planting at Unity and Milimani primary schools.

We were joined by the National Environmental Management Authority (NEMA) who enlightened us on the importance of growing trees and need for environmental conservation.

The approach of planting trees in institutions ensures survival through adaptation. The pupils and young volunteers will take care of the trees and offering and responsibility.

Team building activities which achieved the following;

- Coordination and team work.
- Group sessions on mental health
- Endurance.
- Recreation.

4th Day

At Palliative Care clinic. The team was joined by ACK clergy for Cancer Awareness

Month and doctors and patients with terminal illness. The team planted grass so as to ensure people with chronic diseases finds a place to rest during their monthly meeting. Also the team partitioned the area charged for palliative care and pruned trees.

Cleanup at industrial area. The team was joined County Government officials, Red Cross, YMCA. They engaged in exercise which saw cleanup, unblocking water drainages and collecting waste dumps.

The study of the blue economy

This involved gathering data on the effects of poor waste disposal to the blue economy seeing that at this region is a target by county government to establish fish fingerling joint. Which will be in charge of installing freezers and marketing fishes from the lake Naivasha. Also to fisher men it is a source of income and waste disposed from the town finds its way in to the lake.

The volunteers had fun by engaging in various activities like boat ridding, horse riding and bike riding.



Figure 3 Volunteers pose for a photo at Palliative clinic at Naivasha referral hospital

Summary of beneficiaries

Description	No involved in the sustainability workshop , Training and team building	No involved in the community service .
YGAK volunteers	52	52
Maasai Mara University and other Universities	10	15
Groups benefited by the projects	Young people from the township at YMCA center, county interns and Red cross youths	Naivasha sub-county Hospital, industrial area residents , Millimani and unity primary schools ,strong tower and safe house center

CHALLENGES

The following challenges were faced during the preparation and during the implementation stage.

- I. Pre-visit and planning costs in the initial stages which include, travelling, printing, credit and other hidden costs.
- II. Team accommodation costs during the community service.
- III. Budget shortfalls inhibiting actualization of set objectives.
- IV. Documentation and publicity which includes brochures, banners, t-shirts and media coverage to guide awareness, research and study.
- V. Survival of the trees planted in community spaces.
- VI. Sustainability of the impact created during the clean-up and waste management.

Recommendations

- The university to continue with its support of the initiative through provision of transport during the outreach activities and workshops, approval of the subsequent project proposal, partnership with marketing department and play a stakeholder role in the project.
- Awareness and community education on benefits and hazards related to waste management and disposal to be adapted in the subsequent projects to ensure sustained impact.
- Regular workshops and trainings for the volunteers during the life on the project to give them adequate skills in community service and environmental conservation.
- Follow up and progress reports to be prepared quarterly during the life of the project to assess changing

dynamics and address upcoming issues.

- The project to encourage innovation as a means of cost recovery and sustenance.
- Seek research partnership for the volunteers to come up with solutions as well as advise on the best approaches as they advance their careers.

- Include edible trees in the target trees to be grown to promote food and nutrition security.
- For survivability, all trees should be grown in the identified schools, offices and institutions where they have someone to take care for them until they are fully sustainable.